

Jamaica

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** August 6, 1962 **Usage:** National and Civil

Black, green, and yellow are also pan-African colors

Black reflects hardships



Green represents the land

Yellow recalls the sun shining

“Hardships there are but the land is green and the sun shineth” is the local explanation of the flag

North America



Jamaica was a British colony from 1655 until 1962. From 1958 onward it was part of the West Indies Federation, which was dissolved in 1962.

The present design emerged from those sent in by the public in a national competition. It was originally designed with horizontal stripes, but this was too similar to the then Tanganyikan flag, and so the saltire was substituted.

The coat of arms, based on those granted to Jamaica on February 3, 1663, is among the oldest granted to

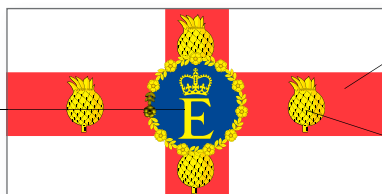
a British colony. It was used on the former British flags of Jamaica.

THE QUEEN'S STANDARD

The flag for HM Queen Elizabeth II, was introduced after independence. It contains a banner of the arms, with the Queen's Cypher in the center. The field depicts the red Cross of St. George charged with pineapples.

BANNER OF THE QUEEN OF JAMAICA

The Royal Cypher is enclosed within a chaplet of roses



St. George's Cross

The four pineapples and cross are taken from the Arms of Jamaica